this was how the LTTE usually made people bond with each other in their fight against New Delhi. Also, as Murugan revealed, this would have helped Nalini bond with the new girls coming to Madras as well.

At the beginning of May, Murugan revealed, Sivarasan went back to Jaffna to return with two members of the Black Tigress squad of the LTTE. Their task was to act as human bombs. Sivarasan met his bosses Pottu Amman and Prabhakaran and took them through the progress of work in Madras until then. It was at that meeting that Prabhakaran asked Sivarasan to undertake ‘dry runs’ before the actual operation. Amman instructed him to photograph the entire exercise and send the results to Jaffna. This was a shocking revelation for the interrogators.[2]

Kaarthikeyan asked Murugan to explain these ‘dry runs’. The latter said they were basically rehearsals before the main act, where all steps were to be followed, barring the final act—the bombing itself. The human bomb would carry the bomb without the explosive device. His admission shocked everyone in the room. None of those investigation veterans and experts in understanding criminal minds had ever heard of such ‘dry runs’ where the intended target would have multiple security cordons around them.

Murugan must have enjoyed watching the shock on his interrogators’ faces. He continued that Sivarasan returned to India with the two human bombs—Dhanu alias Gayathri, and Shubha. They reached Nagapattinam with the help of a local facilitator at night. Murugan was present with the local facilitator and received Sivarasan, whom he had ‘immense respect and admiration’ for. They all headed for Madras.[3]

Murugan’s confession was revealing so much that the interrogators didn’t want to leave the room. The tough-looking member of the LTTE’s hit squad continued, for whom the next step was to procure the explosives—the C4 variety of RDX.

Kanth confronted him with their findings of the Padmanabha assassination case. He pointed out that the same variety of explosives and grenades were used in both the assassination cases. Murugan didn’t deny having used RDX—the same green-coloured plastic explosive Sivarasan had used to kill Padmanabha. He admitted that the LTTE’s network in Tamil